

wanted nothing to do with it, and the infant was left outside to die. The infant's one and only chance of survival was if a stranger found it, in which case the child would be brought up as a slave.

Child killing seems very cruel today. But a new baby was another mouth to feed. If the child was born to a poor family, where the father couldn't provide any more food, it's not difficult to see why he might choose to let it die.

By 374 CE, under the rule of Emperor Valentinian, a father's right of life or death over his children had more or less come to an end. From then on, a father who committed such a terrible act was guilty of murder.

Naming baby

Boys were named 9 days after they were born, and girls when they were 8 days old. At a naming ceremony, prayers were said and a male baby was given a round lucky charm (*bulla*) to wear around his neck, and a baby girl was given a crescent-moon-shaped amulet called a *lunula*. A boy wore his *bulla* until his 16th birthday. Only then could he remove it to show that he had become an adult.

Women and marriage

A girl removed her *lunula* on the eve of her wedding day—usually when she was 14 or 15. That was the day she was “placed in the hands,” as the Romans said, of her husband. From then on, she was his responsibility, not her father's. Boys were allowed to marry from the age of 14, although most married in their late teens or early twenties.

Most marriages were arranged between the heads of the two families involved. A girl might not even know the name of her husband-to-be until after her

CHILDREN PLAYED WITH TOYS SUCH AS DOLLS, MODEL SOLDIERS AND ANIMALS, HOOPS, AND MARBLES.

